START FROM SCRATCH / HYPER-PACED LEARNING

Week 2: Make your first model call

Move from chatting in a browser to building a small application that sends a request to a model and uses the response in a purposeful workflow.

01. INPUT
An incident or user request.

02. INSTRUCT
A clear prompt and expected output.

03. CALL
Your application contacts a model.

04. USE
Show a helpful, structured response.

The move from chat to an application

In a chat interface, the product handles the model call for you. In Week 2, your code or workflow becomes the product: it assembles the input, chooses the instructions, sends the request, receives a response, and presents it to a user.

One shared problem

Every team tackles the Automated Triage Agent: a Level 1 SRE assistant that classifies technical errors and suggests a resolution.

Different ways to build it

The challenge remains the same while each team works in a different environment. Compare choices, not just outputs.

A model call is not magic. It is an engineered handoff: input plus instructions go in; a response comes back; your application decides what to do with it.

THE MODEL CALL

What every implementation has in common

The visual interface and coding language may differ. The underlying loop stays recognisable across every group.

Component	Purpose	What good looks like
User input	The error message, incident summary, or question the system needs to process.	Specific, realistic sample cases with no sensitive data.
Instructions	Tell the model its role, task, limits, and expected answer format.	Clear classification and resolution fields, not vague requests.
Model call	Your app or workflow sends the input and instructions to an AI model.	Credentials remain private; failures are handled clearly.
Response	The model returns a suggested classification, explanation, and next action.	Useful output is visible, understandable, and ready for review.

Keep your first build simple

Build the smallest complete path

One input, one model call, and one understandable output are enough for the first version. Improve reliability and clarity before adding features.

Keep the 4Ds active

Decide what AI should do, give it usable instructions, evaluate its suggestion, and stay responsible for any decision that follows.

Never paste API keys into slides, repositories, screenshots, or public chat. Use the environment or secret-handling method provided for your team.

FOUR PATHS, ONE CHALLENGE

Choose your implementation route

Each group builds the same Automated Triage Agent. The comparison is part of the learning: what became easier, what became harder, and what trade-offs did the environment create?

GROUP A **Python + local/open LLM** Google Colab; explore a self-hosted or open-source model path.	**GROUP B** **Python SDK + cloud API** Use the core developer approach with a commercial model.
GROUP C **n8n** Build the model call through visual workflow orchestration.	**GROUP D** **Next.js + frontend vibe coding** Build the interaction in a frontend environment using Antigravity.

Shared definition of done

The system accepts an example error or incident, makes a model call, shows a classification and suggested resolution, and clearly identifies uncertainty or an escalation path.

Do not judge success by who used the most advanced tool. Judge it by whether the user can see a clear, useful, and trustworthy model-powered interaction.

BUILD, DEMO, LEARN

Your first Model Call Canvas

Align as a team before implementation. This keeps the build focused on the user problem instead of on the tool alone.

1. Input What technical error or incident will the user provide?	**2. Model role** What should the model be responsible for doing?
3. Output Which fields should make the response useful and easy to assess?	**4. Limits** When should it say “I do not know” or recommend escalation?
5. Test cases Which known, ambiguous, and unsuitable cases will you try?	**6. Demo proof** What will you show that proves the model call works?

Present with purpose

Show more than you tell. Keep the problem statement short, show a real example flowing through the system, share the key technical choice, and use the discussion to learn from other teams.

Week 2 turns AI fluency into a working model call. Week 3 will ground that model with trusted knowledge through RAG.